

TASK 02: Password Security and Phishing Awareness

Introduction

In today's digital world, people use online accounts for communication, banking, education, and social media. Because of this, protecting personal information has become very important. Two major cybersecurity threats are weak passwords and phishing attacks. Understanding these threats can help users stay safe online.

1. Strong Passwords

A strong password is a password that is difficult for attackers to guess or crack. It should be unique, long, and contain different types of characters. Strong passwords is one which must include at least one digit one special character uppercase letter, lowercase letter.

Rules for Creating a Strong Password

1. Use at least 12 characters.
2. Include uppercase and lowercase letters.
3. Add numbers to increase complexity.
4. Use special characters such as @, #, \$, %, and &.
5. Avoid personal information such as names, birthdays, or phone numbers.
6. Use a different password for each account.

Example of a strong password:

T@lha2026!Secure

2. Phishing Awareness

Phishing is a cyberattack in which attackers try to trick users into revealing sensitive information such as passwords, credit card numbers, or personal details. Attackers often pretend to be trusted organizations or individuals.

A phishing attack usually starts with a fake message, email, or website. The attacker creates a sense of urgency or offers a reward to convince the victim to click a link. Once the victim enters their information on a fake website, the attacker steals the data and may use it for fraud or account compromise.

3. Real-Life Examples of Phishing Attacks

A. Email Scams

A user receives an email claiming they have won a prize or that their bank account will be suspended unless they verify their information. The email contains a malicious link that leads to a fake website designed to steal login credentials.

B. Fake Login Pages

Attackers create websites that look almost identical to popular services such as Google, Facebook, or Microsoft. When users enter their username and password, the information is sent directly to the attacker.

C. Social Media Messages

Users may receive messages on social media platforms containing suspicious links. The message may appear to come from a friend or a trusted account. Clicking the link can lead to a fake login page or malware download.

4. Protection Methods

There are several ways users can protect themselves from phishing attacks and password-related threats:

1. Use strong and unique passwords for every account.
2. Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) whenever possible.
3. Verify links and website addresses on [virustotal.com](https://www.virustotal.com) etc before entering credentials.
4. Avoid clicking suspicious links in emails, messages, or social media posts.
5. Keep software and applications updated with the latest security patches.